Day 42 - Pine River Valley, Carl Alexander, Melodonna, Kilgorie, Bell Lookout

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Dufferin Hi-Land section · hike 53 · Pine River valley, Mulmur

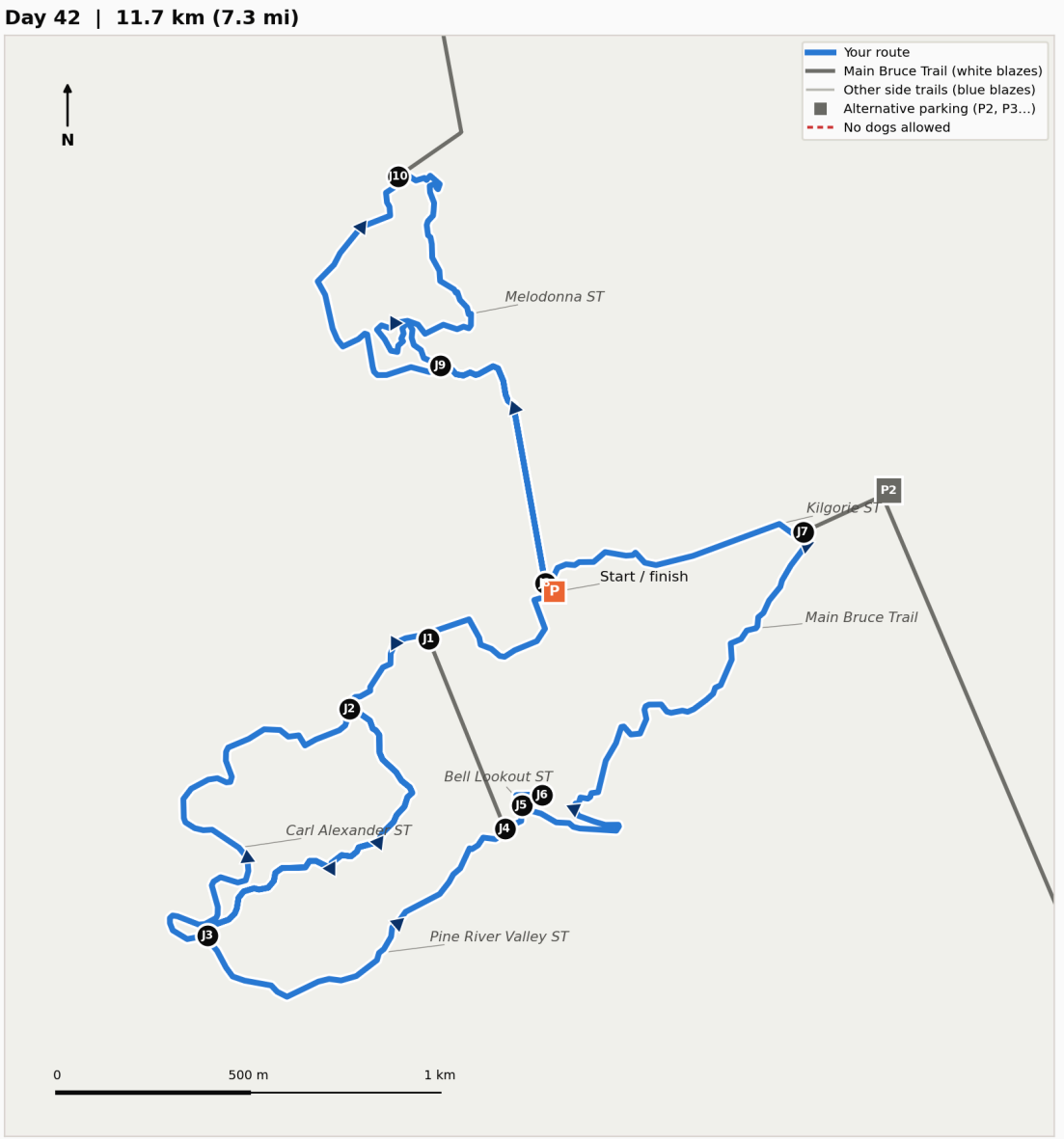
11.7 km / 7.3 mi	~3.6 h	6.0 km new	85 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking on 15 Sideroad at Prince of Wales Rd. NOTE: The only access to this location is from River Rd, 500 m west of Kilgorie. Look for a small road sign, 15 Sideroad, on a sharp curve on River Rd. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day42_hike053.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Pine River Valley Side Trail (2.5 km); Carl Alexander Side Trail (1.4 km); Melodonna Side Trail (1.2 km); Kilgorie Side Trail (0.8 km); Bell Lookout Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on 15 Sideroad at Prince of Wales Rd. The only way in is from River Rd, 500 m west of Kilgorie. Look for a small "15 Sideroad" sign on a sharp curve.
- **Road walking:** Several main-trail stretches follow road shoulders, including a long descent into the Pine River valley. Keep Zappy close.
- **Pine River valley:** A 2015 trip report describes the main trail following the riverbank through the Pine River Provincial Fishing Area. It passes the concrete shell of an old Dufferin Light and Power generating station and runs along the banks of a fishing pond.
- **Bell Lookout Side Trail:** A very short spur to a lookout, a good place for a snack. Nearby the main trail passes through mixed forest and climbs to another lookout.

- **Kilgorie, Carl Alexander, Melodonna and Pine River Valley side trails:** No descriptions of these side trails were found. Expect the climbs and descents of the river valley.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking on Centre Rd (Kilgorie), 30 metres south of River Rd map	Free	7.3	230 m	Kilgorie

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 6.7 km / 4.2 mi, covering Bell Lookout, Carl Alexander, Pine River Valley. **Outing 2** from P2 (Roadside parking on Centre Rd (Kilgorie), 30 metres south of River Rd; Free): 5.7 km / 3.5 mi, covering Kilgorie, Melodonna. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on 15 Sideroad at Prince of Wales Rd. Head west on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail. The next 0.0 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.4	0.2	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.5	0.3	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Pine River Valley Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
0.8	0.5	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Carl Alexander Side Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Pine River Valley Side Trail goes off on your left.)
2.2	1.4	J3: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Pine River Valley Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Pine River Valley Side Trail goes off on your right.)
3.3	2.0	J2: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
4.3	2.7	J3: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Pine River Valley Side Trail, heading south-east. (the Carl Alexander Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
5.4	3.4	J4: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
5.5	3.4	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Bell Lookout Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
5.6	3.5	J6: End of the Bell Lookout Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.7	3.5	J5: Turn sharp left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
7.2	4.5	J7: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Kilgorie Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
8.0	5.0	J8: Turn sharp right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
8.7	5.4	J9: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Melodonna Side Trail goes off ahead.)
9.7	6.0	J10: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Melodonna Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
10.9	6.8	J9: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
11.2	6.9	Heads-up: The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.6	7.2	J8: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the Kilgorie Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
11.7	7.3	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on a Vanderplas family trip report.